to undertake are realized. Your presence on December 31, 1965, and all the mayhem you create, are part of the unchangeable fabric of that universe's reality.

The Many Worlds interpretation offers a similar resolution to the issue of knowledge seemingly materializing from nowhere, as in the scenario of my mother's writing a decisive paper in string theory. According to the Many Worlds interpretation, in one of the myriad parallel universes my mother *does* develop quickly into a string theory expert, and on her own discovers all that I read in her paper. When I undertake my excursion to the future, my time machine takes me to *that* universe. The results I read in my mother's paper while I'm there were indeed discovered by the version of my mother in that world. Then, when I travel back in time, I enter a different one of the parallel universes, one in which my mother has difficulty understanding physics. After years of trying to teach her, I give up and finally tell her what to write in the paper. But in this scenario there is no puzzle regarding who is responsible for the breakthroughs. The discoverer is the version of my mother in the universe in which she's a physics whiz. All that's happened as a result of my various time travels is that her discoveries are communicated to a version of herself in another parallel universe. Assuming you find parallel universes easier to swallow than authorless discoveries—a debatable proposition—this provides a less baffling explanation of the interplay of knowledge and time travel.

None of the proposals we've discussed in this or the previous section are necessarily *the* resolution to the puzzles and paradoxes of time travel. Instead, these proposals are meant to show that puzzles and paradoxes do not rule out time travel to the past since, with our current state of understanding, physics provides possible avenues for end runs around the problems. But failing to rule something out is a far cry from declaring it possible. So we are now led to ask the main question:

Is Time Travel to the Past Possible?

Most sober physicists would answer no. I would say no. But unlike the definitive no you'd get if you asked whether special relativity allows a massive object to accelerate up to and then exceed the speed of light, or